

Updating nftfw manual installations

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Deprecation

This document has not been updated since 2021, and is considerably out of date. It is no longer being linked to actively from other more recent documentation, but stays here just in case.

Get current version

If you've installed *nftfw* from a zip or tar file, then revisit the github pages and pull the current version. Unpack and install the files.

If you used *git*, then change to the your *nftfw* source directory and

```
$ git pull
```

which will pull the files that have changed, and will also tell you if you are up-to-date.

If you've run the *nftfw* system tests, *git* will complain about some new files. In the *nftfw* directory:

```
$ cd tests
$ make clean
```

will remove the files created by the tests, and the *pull* should now work.

To use *git* in future:

```
$ sudo apt install git
# I put my copy in /usr/local/src, and need to be root to install
$ cd /usr/local/src
$ sudo git clone https://github.com/pcollinson/nftfw
```

Re-install the *nftfw* Python modules & programs

```
# cd into the installed nftfw directory
$ sudo pip3 install .
# will uninstall the old version say
Successfully installed nftfw-<version>
```

Re-run the Install.sh script

Will update files in your *etc/nftfw* directory, but will not touch any working files. The *original* directory may contain changes that are useful to you. You can use *diff* to compare your working versions with files in the *original* directory.

The [Incron] section in the *config.ini* file can be deleted as it's no longer used.

Changes for *nftfw* version 0.8 and onwards

Summary of changes from 0.7 requiring some reconfiguration:

- Edit *config.ini* to remove: [Owner] section - ownership of files created in *etc/nftfw* now taken from owner of that directory *nftfw_base* - *nftfw* now uses it's own control files exclusively.

- *etc/nftfw/original* renamed *etc/nftfw/etc_nftfw*
- Change to *nftfw_init.nft* to include essential ipv6 icmp coding. Change to *rule.d/essential-icmpv6.sh*. Can remove reference to this rule in *incoming.d* and *outgoing.d*.
- Updated regular expressions in *exim4.patterns* - now find IP addresses correctly
- Local action rules should be placed in */etc/nftfw/local.d*, so that */rule.d* can be updated by distributions.

Other changes:

- New *import_tool* to import Symbiosis/Sympl configs
- New *Uninstall.sh* to remove manual installation
- Many documentation changes - example files now shown relative to filesystem root - e.g */etc/nftfw* rather than */usr/local/etc/nftfw*.

Changes for *nftfw* version 0.7 and onwards

nftfw has gained a new control directory *etc/nftfw/blacknets.d* which allows you to install files of IP address ranges coded as using CIDR notation. The *blacknets* system provides blocking of a large number of IP networks based on lists of addresses. It can be used to keep whole countries out, or stop access from large organisations with complex address ranges. There's a document [Getting CIDR lists](#) explaining how to get the country lists onto your system. There are other sources of bulk blacklists.

To support the new category of blocking there are some changes to *etc/nftfw/nftfw_init.nft* that need to be installed, when updating - remember to run the *Install.sh* script and then copy *etc/nftfw/originals/nftfw_init.nft* to *etc/nftfw/nftfw_init.nft*. If you've made changes to the installed file, you'll need to edit them in again. It's wise then run

```
$ sudo nftfw -f load
```

to ensure that you have a clean installation.

If you've installed the *systemd* based active file system, then you will need to update */etc/systemd/system/nftfw.path* to include the new *blacknets.d* directory. Copy the *nftfw.path* from the *systemd* directory in the release to */etc/systemd/system/nftfw.path*, the file contains the five lines that are needed. Then tell *systemd* to reload:

```
# sudo systemctl daemon-reload
```

Changes for *nftfw* version 0.6 and onwards

nftfw no longer recommends the use of *incron* to provide a 'active' directory so changes in directories in */usr/local/nftfw_* cause automatic running of the *nftfw load* command. A *systemd* unit that watches directories and calls the command replaces *incron*. If you've installed a previous version then you need to unwind parts of the *incron* support system.

Take these steps if you ran versions of *nftfw* before 0.6 and used *incron*. These steps are shown in other files, but it seems sensible to emphasise them here. These can be done before or after you install the new version. The *systemd* can run with version before 0.6, but 0.6 contains some coding changes to make it work a little better.

First, move to the *nftfw* distribution and replace the *cron.d* file

```
$ cd cronfiles
# check that the paths used in cron-nftfw are correct for you
$ sudo cp cron-nftfw /etc/cron.d/nftfw
$ cd ..
```

then stop *incron* from running *nftfw*:

```
$ sudo rm /etc/incron.d/nftfw
```

Install *systemd* control files from *systemd* in the *nftfw* distribution:

```
$ cd systemd
# check nftfw.path and nftfw.service have correct paths
$ sudo cp nftfw.* /etc/systemd/system
$ cd ..
```

```
# start the path unit only
```

```
$ sudo systemctl enable nftfw.path
$ sudo systemctl start nftfw.path
$ sudo systemctl status
```

```
# DON'T start or enable nftfw.service
```

```
# it will be started when needed by nftfw.path
```

Stop *incron* if it's running and you no longer need it

```
$ sudo systemctl stop incron
$ sudo systemctl disable incron
```

Finally a tip that's hard to find: reload *systemd* if you change the *nftfw* files after installation and starting:

```
$ sudo systemctl daemon-reload
```